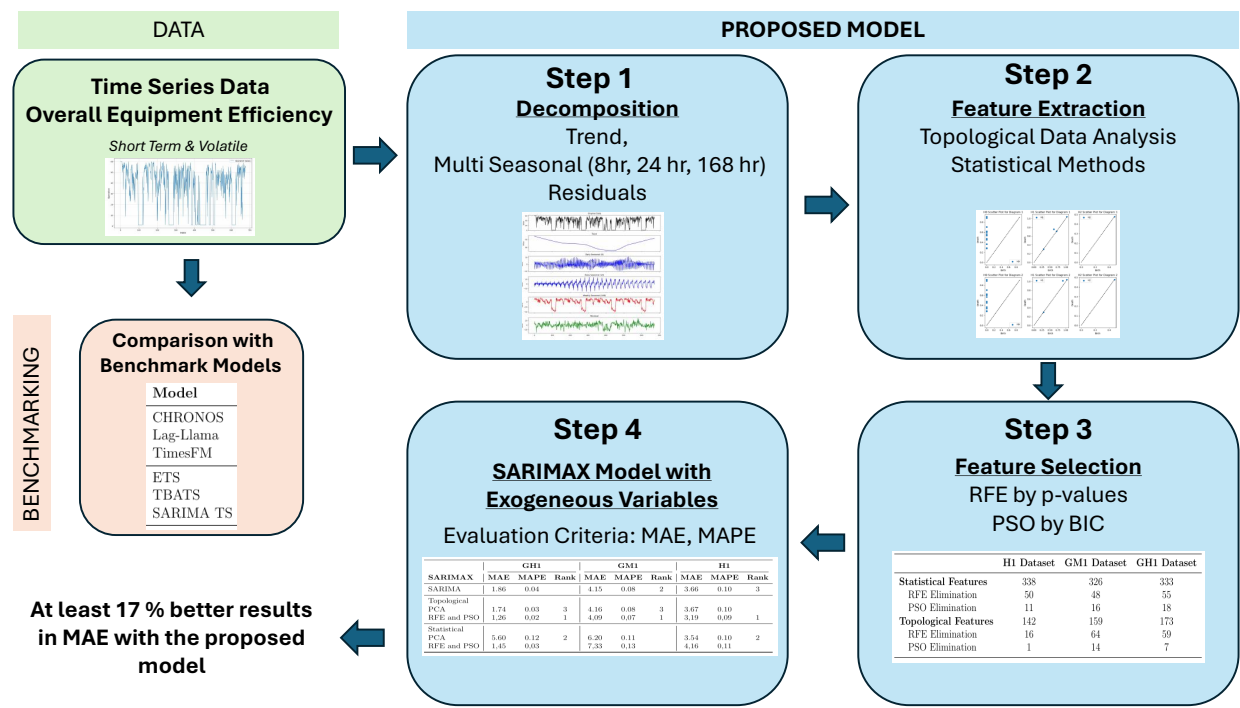


Graphical Abstract

An Overall Equipment Efficiency Predictive Analysis of a Hydraulic Press System by Time Series Forecasting with Topological Features

Ceylan Yozgatlıgil, İsmail Guzel, Korkut Anapa



Highlights

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- Using OEE forecasting to optimize production and maintenance strategies, enabling proactive decision-making for manufacturing teams.
- Leveraging topological feature extraction with time series decomposition to enhance short-term forecasting accuracy for highly volatile OEE data, ensuring reliable predictions in dynamic production environments.
- Managing high-dimensional datasets through an integrated feature selection approach based on SARIMAX as the model, p-values as the evaluation criterion in Recursive Feature Elimination (RFE), and BIC in Particle Swarm Optimization (PSO).

An Overall Equipment Efficiency Predictive Analysis of a Hydraulic Press System by Time Series Forecasting with Topological Features

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Abstract

Overall Equipment Efficiency (OEE) is a key performance indicator in modern manufacturing, yet its volatile nature poses significant challenges for accurate short-term forecasting. In this study, we introduce a novel predictive framework that integrates time series decomposition with topological data analysis (TDA) to enhance OEE forecasting for different production equipments like hydraulic press systems. Our methodology begins by decomposing the hourly OEE data into trend, seasonal, and residual components, thereby isolating the complex short-term fluctuations inherent in production environments. The residual component is modeled using a SARIMAX approach, which is further enhanced by incorporating exogenous variables derived from both statistical measures and TDA-based features such as persistence diagrams, Betti curves, and Heat Kernel representations.

To effectively manage the high-dimensional feature space, we propose an integrated feature selection strategy that leverages Recursive Feature Elimination (RFE) based on SARIMAX p-values, in conjunction with Bayesian Information Criterion (BIC)-guided Particle Swarm Optimization (PSO). The proposed model was evaluated on datasets collected from different manufacturing systems (GM1, GH1, and H1), where it consistently outperformed conventional forecasting models, including ETS, TBATS, and advanced transformer-based methods, as evidenced by significant reductions in Mean Absolute Error (MAE) and Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE).

The results demonstrate that the fusion of classical time series forecasting with TDA not only improves prediction accuracy but also supports proactive maintenance and optimized production teams. This integrated approach provides a robust framework for addressing the challenges posed by volatile OEE data, paving the way for enhanced operational efficiency and data-driven decision-making in industrial environments.

Keywords: Overall Equipment Efficiency, Time Series Forecasting, Time Series Decomposition, Topological Data analysis, Feature Selection

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1. Introduction

1.1. Motivation

Overall Equipment Efficiency (OEE) has become a key metric for assessing and enhancing operational efficiency in modern manufacturing systems. As explained by Nakajima [1], OEE integrates three fundamental components: availability, performance, and quality. This comprehensive measure not only helps identify and categorize productivity losses but also facilitates process improvements by providing actionable insights into resource utilization and equipment performance. Numerous studies have demonstrated the role of OEE as a foundational tool for monitoring and optimizing manufacturing processes, including machines, manufacturing cells, and assembly lines [2, 3]. Through systematic analysis of operational data and the identification of key inefficiencies, OEE supports continuous improvement efforts, aligning manufacturing systems with world-class standards. Moreover, its simplicity and accessibility empower both operators and managers to collaboratively optimize maintenance strategies, minimize breakdowns, and enhance overall productivity [4].

The emergence of Industry 4.0 has further revolutionized OEE measurement and analysis through the integration of interconnected devices, sensors, and advanced data analytics. Today, optimizing maintenance strategies is essential for ensuring operational efficiency. While a limited number of studies have attempted to predict OEE values [11, 12, 13], the development of comprehensive production management strategies remains challenging. This is primarily due to the accuracy limitations in OEE prediction, which hinder the establishment of precise, data-driven decision-making frameworks for production management.

By leveraging historical data and real-time sensor information, manufacturers can forecast OEE trends, enabling predictive maintenance strategies that proactively mitigate potential failures [5]. Time-series analysis plays a pivotal role in this approach, allowing the examination of data collected at specific intervals to identify trends, seasonal fluctuations, and cyclical behaviors in equipment performance. Techniques such as AutoRegressive Integrated Moving Average (ARIMA), exponential smoothing, and seasonal decomposition enable the modeling of time-dependent patterns, facilitating precise maintenance scheduling and anomaly detection [6, 7]. These predictive capabilities help reduce unplanned downtime, lower maintenance costs, and extend equipment lifespan, ultimately improving productivity and operational efficiency. Additionally, the integration of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Machine Learning (ML) enhances predictive accuracy, optimizing production processes and ensuring a competitive edge in dynamic markets [5].

In modern manufacturing environments, OEE data often exhibits high variability due to rapid advancements and continuous improvements in production processes. This underscores the need for short-term data analysis to accurately capture and respond to swift changes in equipment performance. Implementing real-time OEE monitoring systems enables manufacturers to quickly detect and address inefficiencies, leading to improved operational performance [8]. Furthermore, machine learning and data analytics facilitate the development of predictive models that anticipate fluctuations in equipment efficiency, allowing for proactive maintenance and optimization strategies [9]. By focusing on short-term data analysis, organizations can effectively navigate the inherent volatility in OEE metrics, ensuring sustained productivity and competitiveness despite the rapid evolution of production technologies [8, 9].

Forecasting time-series data that is highly volatile and short-term presents significant challenges due to the presence of both chaotic and non-chaotic components. Reliable and consistent predictions often require extensive datasets, yet traditional methods may struggle to extract meaningful patterns from noisy and dynamic time series. Our motivation for this study is to develop a novel method that addresses these challenges and offers the following key benefits:

- **Improved Predictive Maintenance:** By forecasting dips or fluctuations in OEE in advance, maintenance teams can take proactive measures. Since OEE declines often signal impending machine failures or inefficiencies, accurate predictions allow for scheduled maintenance before severe performance degradation or breakdowns occur. This minimizes unplanned downtime and ensures higher equipment availability.
- **Enhanced Production Scheduling and Resource Allocation:** Reliable OEE forecasts enable production managers to adjust schedules and resource deployment based on anticipated equipment performance changes. For instance, if the model predicts lower machine efficiency for the following day, managers can redistribute production loads or adjust work shifts accordingly. Conversely, during periods of high predicted OEE, operations can run at full capacity. This approach ensures optimal utilization of machinery and labor, contributing to resilient and efficient manufacturing systems aligned with Industry 4.0 objectives.
- **Handling Volatility and Noise:** One of the primary motivations for this study is the ability to capture complex, short-term patterns that traditional forecasting methods often overlook. Our approach is designed to handle the volatile nature of production environments more effectively. By incorporating noise-robust analysis techniques, we can smooth out random fluctuations while preserving meaningful deviations. This leads to more stable forecasts with fewer unexpected variations, ultimately improving confidence in production planning.
- **Competitive Advantage:** Accurate OEE forecasting provides manufacturers with a strategic advantage by ensuring consistently high equipment effectiveness. By leveraging predictive insights for proactive decision-making, companies can minimize unexpected losses, reduce operational costs, and meet production targets with greater reliability. In a competitive market, maintaining high OEE levels translates into better responsiveness to demand fluctuations, improved productivity, and overall enhanced manufacturing performance.

By addressing these challenges, our study aims to develop an advanced OEE forecasting approach that enhances predictive maintenance, optimizes production efficiency, and provides manufacturers with the insights needed to stay competitive in rapidly evolving industrial landscapes.

1.2. Literature Review

1.2.1. OEE

OEE was introduced as part of Total Productive Maintenance (TPM) to evaluate equipment efficiency [1]. Its calculation involves availability, which measures the proportion of

scheduled time the equipment is available; performance, which assesses the equipment’s operating speed compared to its designed speed; and quality, which evaluates the proportion of defect-free products. A perfect OEE score of 100% represents ideal manufacturing, where equipment operates at full speed without stoppages or defects [14]. OEE plays a critical role in manufacturing by highlighting inefficiencies in production [15], guiding continuous improvement initiatives [16], and enabling comparisons across production lines and facilities [14]. The ability to monitor and improve OEE ensures manufacturers remain competitive in dynamic markets [17]. The Fourth Industrial Revolution (4IR) has revolutionized OEE measurement and management by integrating advanced technologies such as the Internet of Things (IoT), machine learning, and big data analytics [18]. These innovations allow for real-time OEE monitoring and predictive analytics, providing manufacturers with actionable insights [19]. Examples include real-time monitoring through IoT-enabled sensors that provide continuous data on equipment performance [20], predictive analytics using machine learning models to forecast potential failures and OEE trends [21], and enhanced decision-making with advanced analytics optimizing resource allocation and maintenance schedules [18]. Traditionally, OEE is analyzed using statistical process control methods. This approach identifies losses and inefficiencies [17], such as downtime losses due to equipment failures, speed losses caused by suboptimal operating conditions, and quality losses resulting from defects. Studies have demonstrated the effectiveness of these methodologies in improving production performance [15]. With 4IR technologies, OEE management has transitioned from reactive to proactive strategies [19]. Advanced data analytics enables accurate forecasting, where predictive models estimate OEE trends, helping managers anticipate and address inefficiencies [21]. It also optimizes resource management by providing insights that improve team management and resource allocation [20], and reduces losses by targeting root causes of inefficiencies [18]. Forecasting OEE is essential in modern manufacturing for enhancing production planning and scheduling [19], minimizing downtime through proactive maintenance [21], and improving decision-making through accurate predictions [18]. Such advancements ensure manufacturing systems are resilient, efficient, and capable of meeting market demands. The integration of 4IR technologies into OEE management represents a paradigm shift in manufacturing. By leveraging advanced data analytics and IoT, manufacturers can not only monitor but also predict and optimize equipment performance. Future research should focus on refining predictive models and exploring their applications across diverse manufacturing sectors.

1.2.2. Forecasting

The evolution of forecasting methodologies has seen significant developments over the decades, beginning with traditional statistical models and advancing to complex ML and AI techniques. ARIMA models have long been a cornerstone in time series forecasting due to their ability to capture linear relationships in stationary datasets [22]. These models rely on identifying appropriate orders for autoregressive and moving average components, often complemented by differencing to ensure stationarity. Despite their strengths, ARIMA models face challenges when handling non-linear relationships and data with high volatility [23].

With the growing demand for accuracy in forecasting, particularly in industrial and financial domains, ML and AI models have emerged as robust alternatives. Methods such as

support vector regression (SVR), random forests, gradient boosting machines (GBMs), and neural networks have demonstrated superior performance in capturing complex non-linear dependencies [24, 25]. The integration of exogenous variables, such as statistical features derived from historical data, has further enhanced the predictive capabilities of these models [26]. For instance, incorporating seasonality indices, moving averages, and lagged features has been shown to improve the accuracy of forecasts, particularly in scenarios involving external influences [27].

A recent frontier in forecasting involves the inclusion of topological features derived from time series data. These features, calculated using tools such as persistent homology, provide insights into the geometric and topological structure of data [28]. Topological Data Analysis (TDA) has proven particularly effective in handling volatile and short-term datasets, where traditional statistical and ML models may falter. The use of persistence diagrams, Betti curves, and persistence entropy allows models to capture intrinsic properties of data that are otherwise overlooked. For example, TDA-based features have been utilized in financial markets to predict stock price movements, demonstrating their utility in environments characterized by high uncertainty [29].

In conclusion, the integration of ARIMA, ML, and AI models, supplemented by exogenous variables, has significantly advanced the field of forecasting. Topological features, in particular, represent a promising avenue for enhancing predictions in volatile and short-term data scenarios, making them an essential component of modern forecasting techniques.

1.2.3. Topological Data Analysis

TDA has emerged as a powerful tool for analyzing complex and high-dimensional datasets, particularly in the presence of noise. One of its key advantages lies in its resilience to noise and its ability to extract meaningful patterns from the overall structure of data. TDA operates on the premise that data has an inherent shape, and it utilizes this shape to identify topological features such as clusters, loops, and voids, which remain consistent despite perturbations in the data [30]. This approach has been successfully applied in multivariate time series studies, such as room occupancy data analysis, yielding improved prediction accuracy compared to traditional methods. The integration of TDA into time series forecasting pipelines offers promising advancements for achieving accurate and reliable predictions in dynamic environments, paving the way for future research and applications [47].

The primary method of TDA, *Persistent Homology*, tracks the changes in these features across multiple scales, identifying persistent patterns that are more likely to represent significant underlying structures rather than noise [31]. Persistent homology visualizes these patterns using persistence diagrams or barcodes and allows for quantitative comparison through metrics such as bottleneck distance and Wasserstein distance.

Additionally, the Mapper algorithm, another key tool in TDA, provides a visual representation of data as graphs, enabling qualitative exploration of data structures and facilitating dimensionality reduction [32, 33]. However, the computational complexity of persistent homology, especially for large-scale or high-dimensional datasets, and the parameter dependency of Mapper highlight the ongoing challenges in the field [34].

Despite these challenges, TDA’s capacity to handle noise, analyze multi-scale structures, and integrate with machine learning techniques has been demonstrated across domains including biomedical imaging, financial analytics, and intelligent transportation, making it a

versatile tool for modern data analysis [35, 36]. The TDA features extraction pipeline can be seen in Figure 1 [47] .

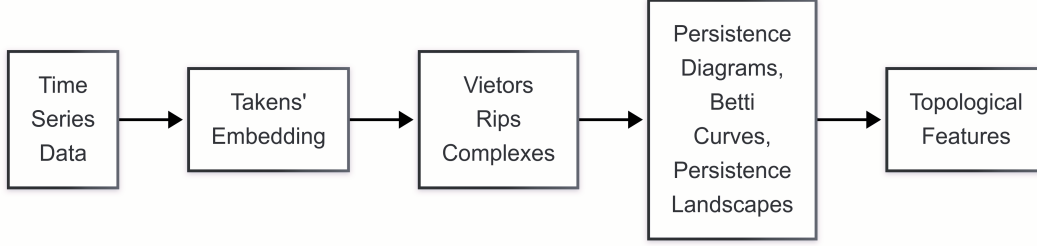


Figure 1: Flowchart of the topological feature extraction

The remainder of this paper is structured as follows: Section 2 outlines the methodology, detailing the main steps involved. Section 3 provides a comprehensive explanation of the feature selection methods. Section 4 introduces the forecasting models. Section 5 presents the results, while Section 6 offers a discussion of the findings.

2. Methodology

With the advent of emerging technologies, many production plants now monitor OEE values in real-time. This capability enables the idea of forecasting OEE values, thereby facilitating the effective management of maintenance and production teams to improve the OEE values of the equipment. The proposed methodology integrates seamlessly with OEE monitoring systems and can be employed online to maintain or improve the stability of OEE trends.

In modern manufacturing plants, the technologies utilized in production equipment evolve rapidly, and continuous improvements are implemented to achieve higher efficiency levels. Consequently, forecasting models for OEE values must rely on short-term historical data to account for the dynamic nature of production environments.

Another critical aspect is the high volatility of OEE values, which arises from factors such as equipment breakdowns, setup changes, and quality-related issues. These challenges necessitate robust forecasting methodologies capable of handling the inherent variability in OEE data while providing actionable insights for operational decision-making.

Forecasting a time series with a short-term historical dataset and a volatile structure is a challenging task. To address this challenge, we propose a novel methodology designed specifically to handle these complexities.

2.1. Importance of the Proposed Model

1. **Robust Forecasting with Short-Term, Volatile Data:** The proposed model is designed to generate reliable forecasts using short-term datasets characterized by high volatility, a common challenge in dynamic production environments.
2. **Practical Applicability in Real-World Manufacturing:** The forecasting accuracy achieved by the model enables informed decision-making and efficient resource management in production facilities.

3. **Enhanced Forecasting Through Time Series Decomposition:** By decomposing time series data into trend, seasonal, and residual components, the model improves forecasting accuracy by effectively capturing distinct patterns in each component.
4. **Optimized Feature Extraction via Topological Data Analysis:** The integration of Topological Data Analysis (TDA) enables the extraction of meaningful geometric features, while a rigorous feature selection process ensures that only the most relevant information contributes to improved predictive performance.
5. **Improved Predictive Maintenance and Operational Efficiency:** Accurate short-term forecasts, combined with robust feature extraction, support proactive maintenance strategies, minimizing unplanned downtime and enhancing overall operational efficiency.

2.2. Description of Our Methodology

The methodology begins with short term hourly OEE data that exhibit fluctuations and high volatility, stemming from dynamic production processes. To address this complexity, the time series is decomposed into three distinct components: the trend, seasonal components, and residuals. This decomposition enables targeted modeling of each component, improving forecasting accuracy and robustness. Figure 2 provides a visual summary of the methodology.

The trend component captures the overall movement in OEE values and is forecasted using the Exponential Smoothing State Space Model (ETS), which effectively models gradual changes over time. Seasonal components represent periodic patterns due to production cycles, such as 8-hour shifts, daily (24-hour), and weekly (168-hour) cycles. These components are modeled and forecasted as periodic values, reflecting recurring production patterns. The residuals, which represent irregular variations and noise not captured by the trend or seasonality, are forecasted with S/ARIMA. The residual forecasting is further enhanced with features derived from TDA and statistical measures, enabling the models to capture intricate and volatile patterns.

The extracted feature set is extensive, making feature selection a critical step in the methodology. We applied a well-defined approach, which combines Recursive Feature Elimination (RFE) and Particle Swarm Optimization (PSO).

Using the extracted features, the proposed model employs a **SARIMAX** approach for forecasting. The model integrates statistical and topological features as exogenous variables to enhance predictive accuracy. By leveraging these additional informative inputs, the SARIMAX model effectively captures both temporal dependencies and complex feature interactions, improving overall forecast performance. The trend and seasonal components have been individually forecasted, and their outputs are then integrated with the forecasted residual component derived from the decomposition process, providing a comprehensive representation of the overall OEE pattern.

The outputs of forecasting models are evaluated through the best model selection process, which identifies the optimal approach based on predefined performance criteria such as Mean Absolute Error (MAE) and Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE). This iterative evaluation ensures that the most accurate and robust forecasting method is selected.

Additionally, a benchmark set is established by applying classical forecasting approaches alongside recent transformer-based foundation models. This benchmarking allows for a comparative evaluation, assessing the effectiveness of the proposed SARIMAX model against both traditional statistical methods and state-of-the-art deep learning architectures.

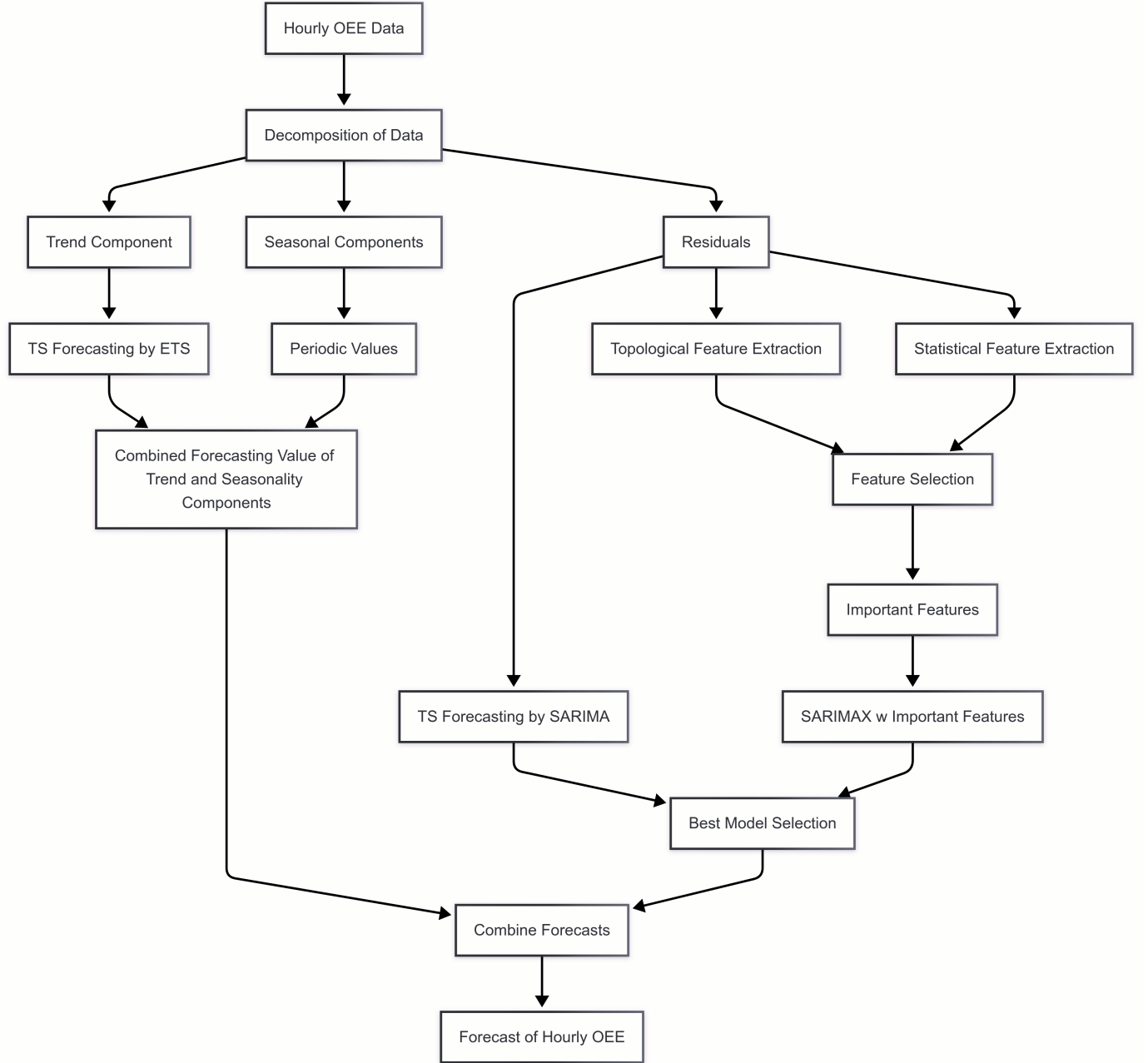


Figure 2: Flowchart of the proposed method

We will further elaborate on the application of the proposed model across different datasets.

2.3. Data

In this study, we utilize three datasets collected from different equipment, labeled as GM1, GH1, and H1. GH1 and GM1 are advanced, highly complex systems that manufacture the inner body group of standard household appliances, while H1 is a hydraulic press system with four presses dedicated to producing stainless steel body parts. The equipment can be seen in Figure 3 and 4.

To evaluate the generality of the proposed model across different types of equipment, we apply it to these three distinct systems, each exhibiting unique operational characteristics and complexities. This assessment ensures the robustness and adaptability of the model in diverse manufacturing environments.



Figure 3: Production Equipment GH1



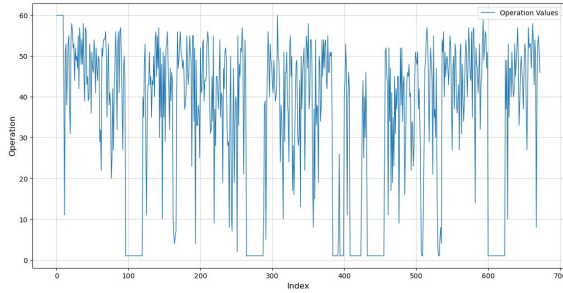
Figure 4: Production equipment H1

Each dataset represents hourly OEE values, ranging between 1 and 60, where 1 indicates no operation, and 60 indicates full operation. The datasets exhibit high variability, as indicated by the standard deviation values, and include a wide range of operational states from the minimum to the maximum. Table 1 is a summary of the statistical properties of the datasets.

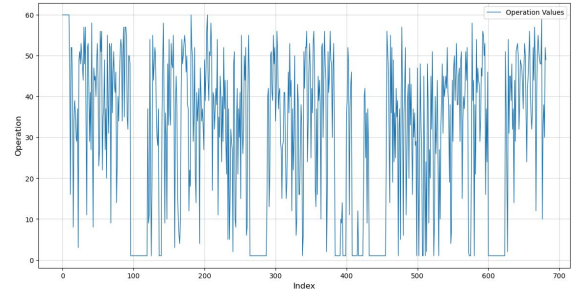
Statistic	GM1 Operation	GH1 Operation	H1 Operation
Count	682.00	673.00	679.00
Mean	29.85	34.09	35.09
Std Dev	19.57	19.81	20.72
Min	1.00	1.00	1.00
25th Percentile	9.00	17.00	18.50
Median (50%)	36.00	41.00	43.00
75th Percentile	47.00	50.00	52.00
Max	60.00	60.00	60.00

Table 1: Statistical Summary of the Datasets

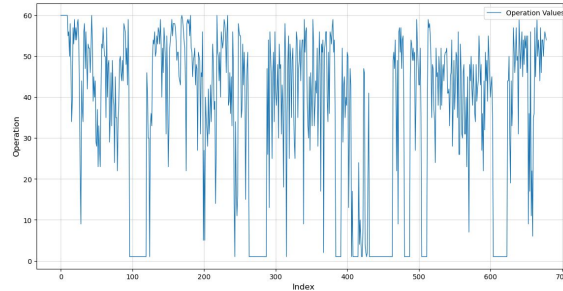
As one can see, the datasets consist of approximately 680 hours of data, representing short-term observations over a period of approximately one month. The standard deviation across the datasets is at least 19.57, indicating high volatility within the data range of 1 to 60. This variability reflects the dynamic nature of equipment operation, emphasizing the need for robust forecasting methodologies to manage such fluctuations effectively. The time series plots of the datasets are given in Figure 5.



(a) Time series plot of hourly OEE values (1-60) of GH1



(b) Time series plot of hourly OEE values (1-60) of GM1



(c) Time series plot of hourly OEE values (1-60) of H1

Figure 5: Time series of datasets belong to different equipment

In Figure 6, the histogram of OEE values for equipment H1 is shown. Normality

tests—including the Shapiro-Wilk test, D’Agostino and Pearson’s test, and the Anderson-Darling test—indicated that the time series deviates from normality. Furthermore, the skewness and kurtosis were calculated as -0.69 and -1.04, respectively, underscoring the need for forecasting methodologies that can effectively handle non-normal distributions.

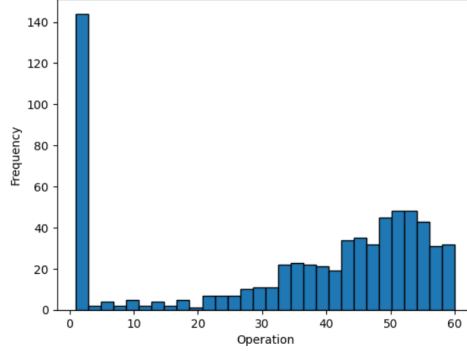


Figure 6: Histogram of OEE values of equipment H1

In the time series plots of the datasets, a complex structure of seasonality is evident. From a domain expert perspective, the datasets are assumed to exhibit multiple seasonalities. The possible seasonality values include 8 hours (shift duration), 24 hours (daily cycles), and 168 hours (weekly cycles). These periodic patterns are crucial for understanding the operational characteristics of the equipment. The decomposition plots of the datasets, illustrating these seasonal components, are summarized in Figure 7.

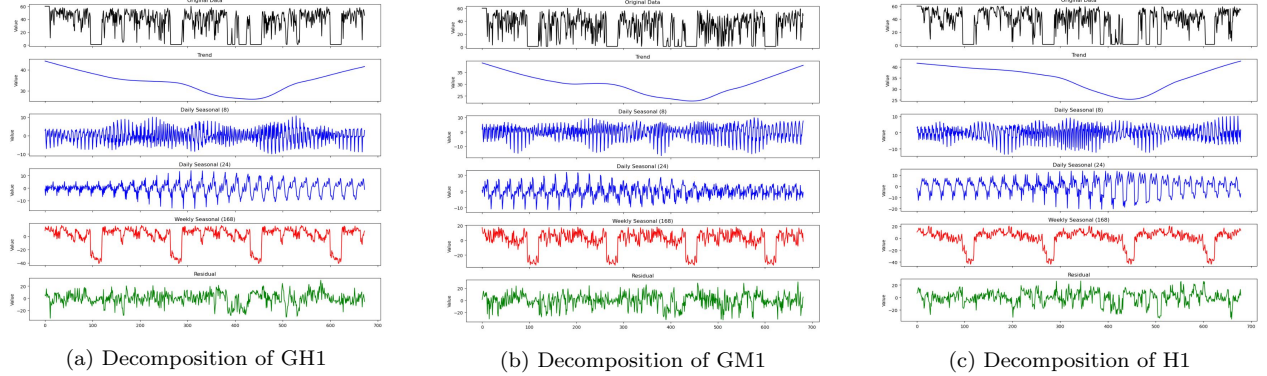


Figure 7: Decomposition plots of datasets belong to different equipment

After decomposition, the residual component of the OEE time series data as depicted in bottom plots of Figure 7 approximates a normal distribution, representing a significant improvement. The decomposition approach effectively mitigates the original non-normality of the data.

In time series forecasting, stationarity is a critical requirement. To ensure this, we evaluated the need for both regular and seasonal differencing. The Kwiatkowski–Phillips–Schmidt–Shin (KPSS), Osborn–Chui–Smith–Birchenhall (OCSB), and Canova–Hansen (CH)

tests confirmed that the series are stationary in both respects, a validation that is essential for effectively applying time series models and achieving reliable forecasts.

Figure 8 displays the Autocorrelation Function (ACF) and Partial Autocorrelation Function (PACF) graphs of the residual component as derived for the SARIMA model.

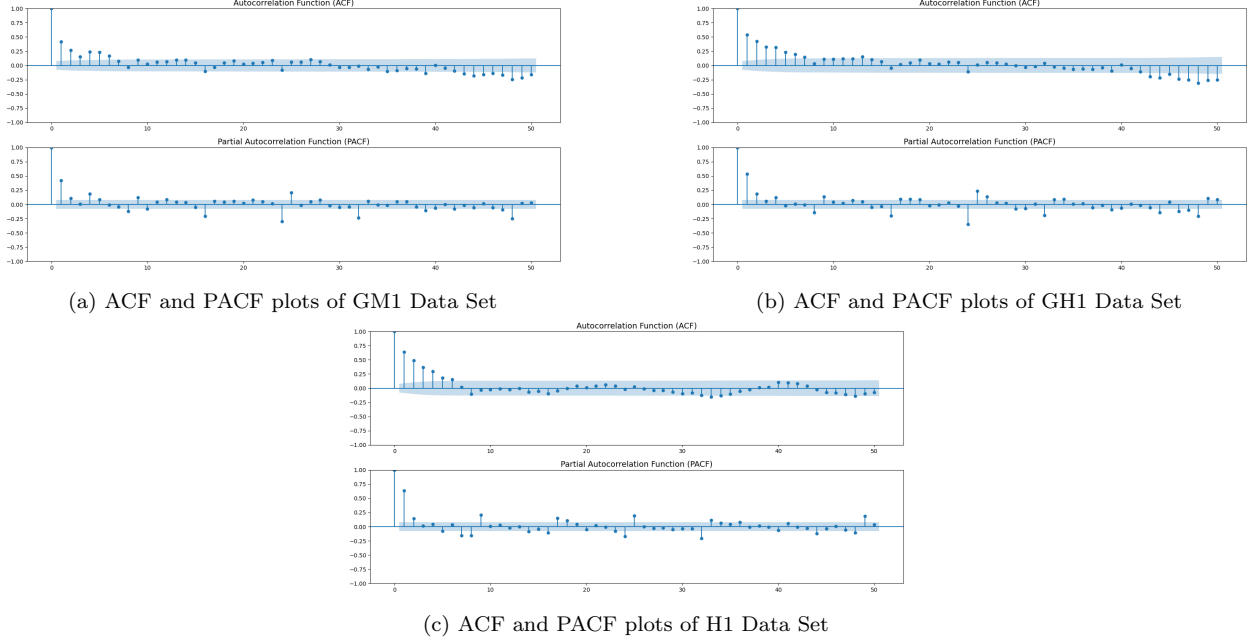


Figure 8: ACF and PACF plots of Data Sets

Forecasting methods typically require the incorporation of exogenous variables to enhance model performance. These variables are extracted using traditional statistical techniques as well as innovative approaches like topological data analysis (TDA). In the following sections, we delve deeper into the feature extraction process to generate the exogenous variables used in SARIMAX.

2.4. Statistical Feature Extraction

Using the `tsfresh` library, a comprehensive set of statistical features is extracted from the residual component of OEE time series data [37].

- **Descriptive and Deviation Metrics:** This group includes basic statistical measures that describe the central tendency and dispersion of the data, such as the sum, mean, median, standard deviation, variance, skewness, kurtosis, and root mean square. In addition, features like absolute energy, mean absolute change, and mean second derivative central capture the magnitude of deviations and the rate of change within the series.
- **Frequency Domain Features:** By applying Fourier analysis, frequency domain characteristics are derived. This category comprises Fourier coefficients (including their real, imaginary, absolute, and angular components) and aggregated statistics such as centroid, variance, skewness, and kurtosis. These features help to reveal dominant frequencies and periodic patterns in the data.

- **Autocorrelation and Temporal Dependency Measures:** To quantify the persistence and repeating patterns in the time series, autocorrelation and partial autocorrelation features are computed over multiple lags. Aggregated autocorrelation metrics provide an overall assessment of the temporal dependencies within the data.
- **Entropy and Complexity Measures:** Entropy-based features, including sample entropy, approximate entropy, permutation entropy, and Fourier entropy, are extracted to assess the complexity and randomness inherent in the time series. These measures are crucial for evaluating the predictability of the data.
- **Trend and Change Quantile Analysis:** Additional features capture the linear trend characteristics (e.g., slope, intercept, and associated statistics) as well as change quantile metrics, which summarize how the signal shifts over time. These features aid in identifying systematic changes and trends in the series.

The basic idea to extract features by windowing can be seen in Figure 9

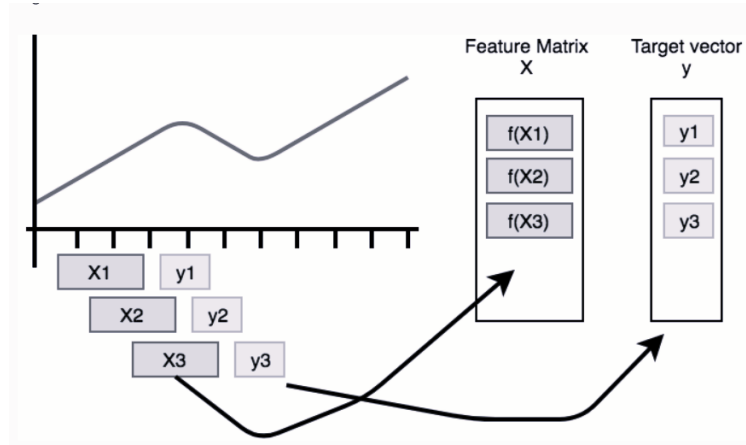


Figure 9: The idea of extracting features by windowing [37].

2.5. Topological Feature Extraction

The proposed methodology leverages TDA to extract a rich set of features from time series data, thereby enhancing forecasting accuracy and supporting advanced analytical applications. This section details both the overall extraction process and the underlying principles of its key components.

Initially, the raw time series is converted into an array and segmented into overlapping windows using a sliding window transformation (with a window size of 24 and a stride of 1). This segmentation preserves local temporal dynamics by isolating short-term patterns within each window. Each window is then embedded into a higher-dimensional space through Takens Embedding [38], which reconstructs the phase-space trajectories based on a specified time delay (8) and embedding dimension (3). The selection of the time delay, denoted as τ , is critical; it ensures that the successive components of the embedding vector are sufficiently independent, thus faithfully unfolding the dynamics of the original system without introducing redundancy [46].

The time delay τ is typically determined using either the autocorrelation function—choosing the delay at the first zero crossing or when the function decays to $1/e$ of its initial value—or via the average mutual information method by selecting the first local minimum. In contrast, the embedding dimension m is commonly estimated using the False Nearest Neighbors algorithm, which identifies the minimal dimension where false neighbors are minimized, or by applying Cao’s method to detect saturation in dynamical invariants [48]. For each sliding window, the time delay and embedding dimensions are calculated and the representative ones are selected [47].

Following the embedding, the Vietoris–Rips Persistence method is applied to the transformed data. This technique constructs a simplicial complex by connecting points within a chosen distance threshold, and as the threshold varies, it tracks the appearance and disappearance of topological features—such as connected components, loops, and voids—across different scales [39]. The outcome is a persistence diagram that records the “birth” and “death” of these features across homology dimensions H_0 , and H_1 [46]. To ensure consistency and comparability across different data samples, the persistence diagrams are scaled appropriately. The standard feature extraction steps for TDA can be seen in Figure 10 [40] [48].

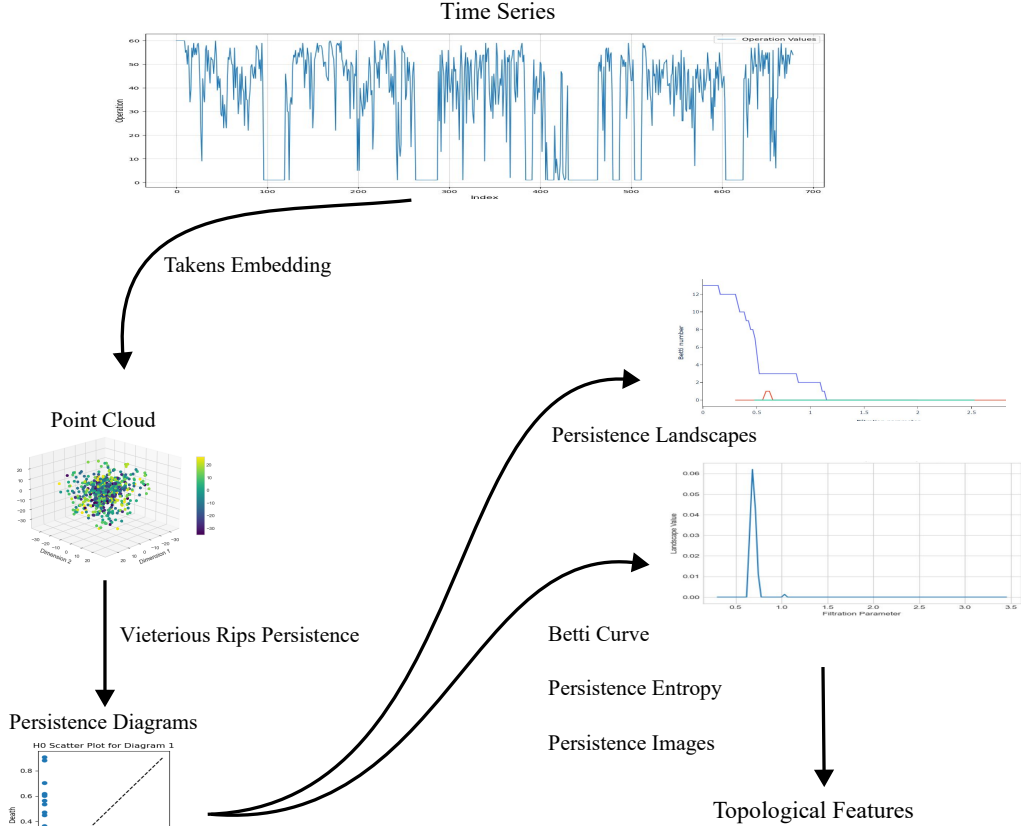


Figure 10: The workflow of TDA feature extraction

A variety of TDA-based feature extractors are then employed on the scaled persistence diagrams. These extractors capture different aspects of the topological signatures in the data:

- **Persistence Entropy:** This extractor computes the Shannon entropy of the lifetimes (i.e., the differences between death and birth times) of topological features, quantifying the overall complexity and disorder in the persistence diagram. Higher entropy values indicate a more uniform distribution of lifetimes, while lower values suggest dominance by a few persistent features [41] [49] .

Let D be a persistence diagram consisting of a set of persistence pairs (b_i, d_i) , where b_i is the birth time and d_i is the death time of a topological feature.

1. **Compute Lifetimes:** The lifetime of each feature is given by:

$$l_i = d_i - b_i \quad (1)$$

where l_i represents the persistence of the feature.

2. **Compute Probability Distribution:** Define the probability mass function:

$$p_i = \frac{l_i}{\sum_j l_j} \quad (2)$$

which normalizes the lifetimes to form a probability distribution.

3. **Compute Shannon Entropy:** The persistence entropy is given by:

$$H = - \sum_i p_i \log p_i \quad (3)$$

where the logarithm is typically taken in base e (natural logarithm).

- **Amplitude Metrics:** These features quantify the "amplitude" of the persistence diagram by measuring distances or functional summaries between features. In particular:

- **Bottleneck Amplitude:** Uses the bottleneck distance to assess the maximum difference between matched features, thus focusing on the most significant topological discrepancies [42].

The *bottleneck distance* between two persistence diagrams D_1 and D_2 is defined as:

$$d_B(D_1, D_2) = \inf_{\gamma} \sup_i \|(b_i, d_i) - \gamma(b_i, d_i)\|_{\infty} \quad (4)$$

where γ ranges over all bijections between the two diagrams and $\|\cdot\|_{\infty}$ is the supremum norm.

- **Wasserstein Amplitude:** Aggregates differences over all matched features to provide a global similarity measure between persistence diagrams.

The *Wasserstein distance* of order p is given by:

$$d_W(D_1, D_2) = \left(\inf_{\gamma} \sum_i \|(b_i, d_i) - \gamma(b_i, d_i)\|^p \right)^{\frac{1}{p}} \quad (5)$$

where the exponent p controls how differences are aggregated [48].

- **Landscape Amplitude:** Leverages persistence landscapes by transforming persistence diagrams into piecewise linear functions, capturing the prominence and overall "energy" of features across scales [49]. The *persistence landscape* function $\lambda_k(t)$ is defined as:

$$\lambda_k(t) = \sup_{\substack{(b_i, d_i) \in D \\ k\text{-th largest}}} \max(0, \min(t - b_i, d_i - t)) \quad (6)$$

where k denotes the level of the landscape. The *landscape amplitude* can then be computed using an L^p -norm:

$$A_p = \left(\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \sum_k |\lambda_k(t)|^p dt \right)^{\frac{1}{p}} \quad (7)$$

• Betti Curves and Persistence Landscapes:

- **Betti Curves:** These plot the number of topological features (i.e., Betti numbers) as a function of the filtration parameter, illustrating how the counts of connected components, loops, or voids evolve over scales. Betti curves describe the evolution of topological features by tracking the Betti numbers $\beta_n(t)$ over a filtration parameter t . The Betti number β_n counts the number of n -dimensional topological features, such as:

$$\beta_0(t) = \text{Number of connected components at filtration level } t \quad (8)$$

$$\beta_1(t) = \text{Number of loops (1-dimensional cycles) at filtration level } t \quad (9)$$

$$\beta_2(t) = \text{Number of voids (2-dimensional cavities) at filtration level } t \quad (10)$$

The Betti curve is then given by:

$$\mathcal{B}_n(t) = \sum_{(b_i, d_i) \in D_n} \mathbf{1}_{[b_i, d_i)}(t) \quad (11)$$

where $\mathbf{1}_{[b_i, d_i)}(t)$ is an indicator function that is 1 if t is within the lifespan of the feature and 0 otherwise [48].

- **Persistence Landscapes:** These provide continuous functional summaries of persistence diagrams by mapping them into a collection of piecewise linear functions. They offer a stable representation that facilitates statistical analysis and integration with machine learning methods [43]. Persistence landscapes transform

persistence diagrams into piecewise linear functions, allowing statistical analysis. The persistence landscape function $\lambda_k(t)$ is defined as:

$$\lambda_k(t) = \sup_{\substack{(b_i, d_i) \in D \\ k\text{-th largest}}} \max(0, \min(t - b_i, d_i - t)) \quad (12)$$

The persistence landscape norm is computed using an L^p -norm:

$$L_p = \left(\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \sum_k |\lambda_k(t)|^p dt \right)^{\frac{1}{p}} \quad (13)$$

- **Silhouette and Heat Kernel Representations:** These representations offer alternative continuous summaries of persistence diagrams.

- **Silhouette Representation:** Computes a weighted average of the persistence landscape, emphasizing the most significant features while reducing noise. This silhouette effectively captures the quality of the topological signature [44].

The silhouette function provides a weighted summary of the persistence landscape, reducing noise while emphasizing significant features. It is defined as:

$$S_\alpha(t) = \frac{\sum_{(b_i, d_i) \in D} (d_i - b_i)^\alpha \lambda_1(t)}{\sum_{(b_i, d_i) \in D} (d_i - b_i)^\alpha} \quad (14)$$

where $\alpha \geq 0$ is a weighting parameter that controls the contribution of each persistence feature. A higher α emphasizes longer-persisting features.

- **Heat Kernel Representation:** Smooths the discrete persistence diagram using a heat diffusion process, yielding a continuous function that encapsulates the global structure of the topological features. This representation is particularly useful for downstream machine learning tasks. The heat kernel representation smooths the persistence diagram using a Gaussian heat diffusion process, transforming the discrete persistence pairs into a continuous function [45]. It is defined as:

$$H(t, \sigma) = \sum_{(b_i, d_i) \in D} \frac{1}{\sqrt{4\pi\sigma^2}} e^{-\frac{(t - \frac{b_i + d_i}{2})^2}{4\sigma^2}} \quad (15)$$

where σ controls the diffusion scale.

Each of these extractors produces a feature matrix that is subsequently flattened and organized into a tabular format. In addition to these TDA features, statistical measures—such as the lifetimes of features and various summary statistics (total, mean, median, variance, standard deviation, maximum, and minimum)—are computed for each homology dimension to further enhance the descriptive power of the dataset.

Finally, all extracted features (including both the TDA descriptors and their statistical summaries) are concatenated into a single, comprehensive feature set. To improve model efficiency and reduce redundancy, feature selection techniques such as low variance elimination and correlation-based filtering are applied. The final refined TDA feature set provides a robust, multi-faceted representation of the time series, capturing both its dynamic behavior and its underlying topological structure, and thereby supporting more accurate forecasting and advanced analytical applications.

3. Feature Selection

In the feature extraction phase, the initial feature set exceeds 450 dimensions. Such high dimensionality not only introduces the well-known *curse of dimensionality* but also hampers the forecasting performance of our models.

To address this, feature selection begins with a low variance elimination step, where features with variance below a threshold of 0.01 are removed. This filtering ensures that only the most informative and discriminative features are retained for use as exogenous variables in forecasting models such as SARIMAX.

Afterward, the primary challenge becomes multicollinearity. By identifying and eliminating dependent columns, the number of features is further reduced. This step prevents redundancy and ensures that retained features provide unique and valuable information.

To further refine feature selection, a smart selection process is implemented to improve machine learning model performance. The idea is to detect and remove highly correlated features, as multiple strongly correlated variables can lead to redundancy and overfitting. Instead of arbitrarily dropping one of the correlated features, their importance is evaluated using a machine learning model—Random Forest in this case. The method selects the most useful features based on their contribution to predicting the target variable.

After these steps, we reduced the number of features to approximately 150 for both topological and statistical feature sets. However, this is still a high dimensionality that may negatively impact forecasting performance.

To further refine the feature set and retain only those features that significantly contribute to forecasting, we design feature selection strategies that align with our objectives. These strategies aim to enhance model interpretability, improve computational efficiency, and optimize predictive performance by systematically selecting the most relevant features.

3.1. Feature Selection via SARIMAX Model Performances

Our proposed method for feature selection is based on statistical significance and the Bayesian Information Criterion (BIC). It consists of two steps. In the first step, features are recursively selected based on their p-values to retain only statistically significant predictors. If further refinement is necessary, an additional feature selection step is performed using Particle Swarm Optimization (PSO) to optimize the final set of features, ensuring both statistical relevance and predictive performance. The flowchart illustrating the feature selection methods is shown in Figure 11.

3.1.1. First Step: Recursive Feature Elimination via p-values

A SARIMAX model is fitted using the available features, and the p-values for the exogenous predictors are computed. Features that exhibit p-values greater than a predefined significance level (e.g., 0.05) are considered statistically insignificant.

This procedure is implemented in a recursive fashion. At each iteration, the SARIMAX model is refitted, and the p-values for all current features are examined. A subset of features with p-values exceeding 0.05 is identified. The least significant features are removed, and the model is refitted on the reduced set. This process repeats until fewer than a set number of features (or none) have p-values above the threshold. This recursive elimination ensures

that only those features that have a statistically significant impact on the target variable are retained.

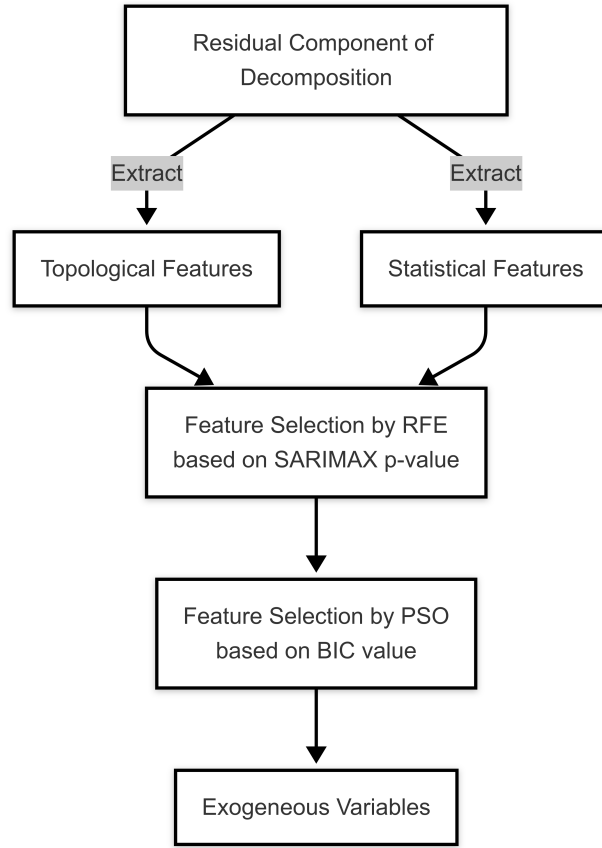


Figure 11: Flowchart of the feature selection methods

3.1.2. Second Step: Feature Elimination by Particle Swarm Optimization (PSO) via BIC

In cases where the feature set remains excessively large after applying the Recursive Feature Elimination (RFE) method, we further refine the selection using Particle Swarm Optimization (PSO). PSO is a population-based stochastic optimization technique inspired by the social behavior observed in flocks of birds or schools of fish. In our framework, each particle in the swarm represents a candidate subset of features, encoded as a binary vector indicating selection. The PSO algorithm iteratively updates the swarm by evaluating the performance of each feature subset using the Bayesian Information Criterion (BIC) of a SARIMAX model fitted on that subset. The objective is to minimize the BIC, which serves as a measure of model quality that penalizes complexity. By doing so, the PSO method effectively searches the space of possible feature combinations to identify a parsimonious subset that leads to superior forecasting performance.

	H1 Dataset	GM1 Dataset	GH1 Dataset
Statistical Features	338	326	333
RFE Elimination	50	48	55
PSO Elimination	11	16	18
Topological Features	142	159	173
RFE Elimination	16	64	59
PSO Elimination	1	14	7

Table 2: Feature Summary for H1, GM1, and GH1 Datasets

To ensure a well-optimized selection process, we configure the PSO parameters as follows: a swarm size of 40 particles, a maximum of 300 iterations, an inertia weight of $\omega = 0.7$ to balance global and local search, and cognitive and social parameters set to $\phi_p = 1.4$ and $\phi_g = 1.8$, respectively, to regulate individual and swarm-wide best solutions. The optimization is executed five times, with BIC values recorded for each run. At the end of these iterations, two feature selection strategies are applied: (i) the feature subset corresponding to the lowest BIC value across all runs is selected as *Set 1*, representing the most optimal feature set; (ii) a secondary feature set is constructed by selecting features that appeared in at least three out of the five runs, ensuring stability and consistency in feature importance.

By implementing this hybrid feature selection framework, we significantly reduce dimensionality while preserving the most informative and discriminative features, ultimately enhancing model interpretability and forecasting performance. The number of extracted and selected features can be seen in Table 2.

4. Forecasting Models

4.1. Benchmark Model Set:

In forecasting step, we first define a benchmark model set. Start with a SARIMA model applied to the given datasets GH1, GM1 and H1 without decomposition. The benchmark forecasting models considered include classical approaches such as **ETS**, and **TBATS**, as well as recent transformer-based foundation models such as **CHRONOS**, **TimesFM**, and **Lag-Llama**.

4.1.1. Exponential Smoothing (ETS)

ETS stands for *Error*, *Trend*, and *Seasonality*, referring to a family of exponential smoothing methods. The ETS framework models the data-generating process by combining three main components. The **Error (E)** represents the type of error process, which can be additive or multiplicative. The **Trend (T)** describes whether there is no trend, an additive trend, or a multiplicative trend. The **Seasonality (S)** indicates whether there is no seasonality, additive seasonality, or multiplicative seasonality [50]. These components are combined in different ways to accommodate a wide range of time series patterns. Because ETS relies on exponential smoothing techniques, it can be highly effective for short-term forecasts and is often robust in the presence of noise.

4.1.2. TBATS Model

The TBATS model is designed to handle complex seasonality and non-integer (potentially multiple) seasonal periods. The name is an acronym representing different components of the model. The **T** refers to trigonometric terms used for modeling seasonality. The **B** denotes the Box-Cox transformation, which stabilizes variance. The **A** represents ARMA errors (AutoRegressive Moving Average) to capture additional temporal dependencies. The second **T** accounts for the trend component, accommodating level or slope changes. The **S** corresponds to seasonal components that may be non-integer or multiple in frequency [51]. By combining these components, TBATS can effectively capture highly irregular seasonal patterns and is especially useful for time series with complex seasonalities, such as daily data with weekly and yearly effects.

4.1.3. Recent Advancements in Time Series Forecasting Models

Recent research has focused on harnessing foundation models—large-scale transformer architectures initially developed for natural language processing—to capture intricate temporal dependencies. Key developments include:

- **Chronos:** Chronos transforms continuous time series data into discrete token sequences through scaling and quantization. It then leverages transformer-based language models (particularly T5 variants) trained with a cross-entropy loss. Pretrained on a diverse set of public and synthetic datasets (via Gaussian processes), Chronos exhibits strong zero-shot performance and adapts well with fine-tuning, thereby simplifying the forecasting pipeline while achieving competitive accuracy [52].
- **Lag-Llama:** Lag-Llama is the first open-source foundation model tailored for univariate probabilistic time series forecasting. Employing a decoder-only transformer architecture that incorporates lagged covariates, it effectively captures long-range dependencies. Trained on a vast, diverse corpus of time series data, Lag-Llama demonstrates robust zero-shot generalization and often outperforms conventional deep learning approaches when fine-tuned on smaller datasets [53].
- **TimesFM:** Developed by Google, TimesFM is a rapid, decoder-only forecasting model designed for out-of-the-box predictions. With a streamlined architecture and minimal preprocessing, TimesFM delivers swift and accurate forecasts, making it particularly well-suited for real-time applications where prediction speed is paramount ? .

4.2. Proposed Model

Our proposed model builds on the strengths of SARIMAX model and featuring power of TDA. We start by decomposing each time series into three distinct components: seasonal, trend, and residual. The seasonal and trend components are forecast using standard forecasting models, while the residual component is modeled via a SARIMAX framework that incorporates exogenous variables. The methodology is depicted in Figure 12. Exogenous variables are extracted from each window of size 24. To prevent data leakage, the forecasted value is always the next one, utilizing exogenous variables derived from the previous 24 time series values [46].

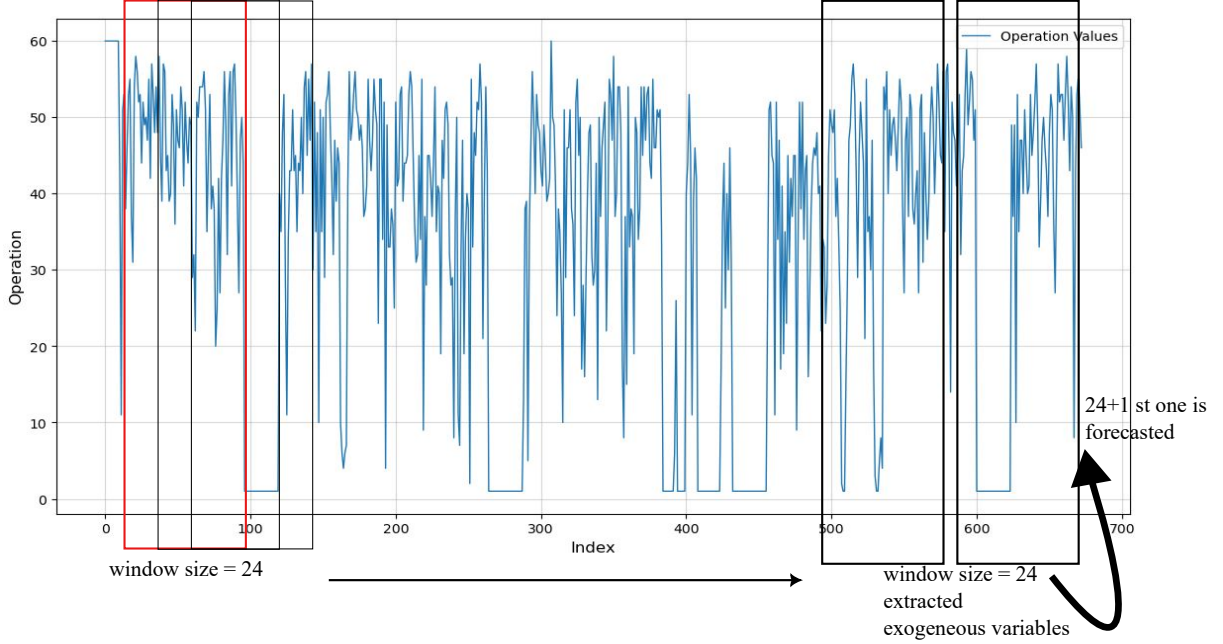


Figure 12: The forecasting strategy for our proposed model

We extract both topological and statistical features from the data. A rigorous feature elimination process is then applied to retain only the most informative predictors. This two-stage strategy enables our model to capture both over all trends and short-term irregularities, thereby enhancing overall forecasting accuracy.

4.2.1. SARIMAX Modeling

Our baseline method employs SARIMAX models, which have long been a standard approach in time series analysis. To determine the appropriate model orders, we analyze the autocorrelation function (ACF) and partial autocorrelation function (PACF) plots of the residual components obtained from the time series decomposition. Based on these plots, the optimal autoregressive (AR) and moving average (MA) orders are selected to capture temporal dependencies effectively.

- For datasets **GM1** and **GH1**, we select a non-seasonal order of $(4, 0, 0)$ combined with a seasonal order of $(1, 0, 1)$ with a seasonal period of 8, yielding the model:

$$\text{SARIMAX}(4, 0, 0)(1, 0, 1)_8.$$

- For dataset **H1**, the non-seasonal order is adjusted to $(2, 0, 0)$ while maintaining the same seasonal specification, resulting in:

$$\text{SARIMAX}(2, 0, 0)(1, 0, 1)_8.$$

5. Results

The results of the benchmark models are presented in Table 3. The table highlights that newer time series models—such as Chronos and Lag-Llama—consistently outperform

traditional approaches like ETS, TBATS, and SARIMA. Notably, Chronos and Lag-Llama achieve strong results without relying on any exogenous variables. Since newer time series models are primarily zero-shot models, the input data consists solely of the time series of the equipment.

Model	GH1			GM1			H1		
	MAE	MAPE	Rank	MAE	MAPE	Rank	MAE	MAPE	Rank
CHRONOS	5,11	0,10	1	5,99	0,17	1	6,09	0,11	3
Lag-Llama	9,13	0,17	2	7,97	0,19	2	3,86	0,07	1
TimesFM	12,56	0,24	3	9,97	0,21	–	10,89	0,20	–
ETS	14,49	0,28	–	8,00	0,19	3	5,02	0,09	2
TBATS	18,43	0,36	–	9,80	0,22	–	8,93	0,16	–
SARIMA TS	21,74	0,42	–	10,09	0,24	–	8,08	0,15	–

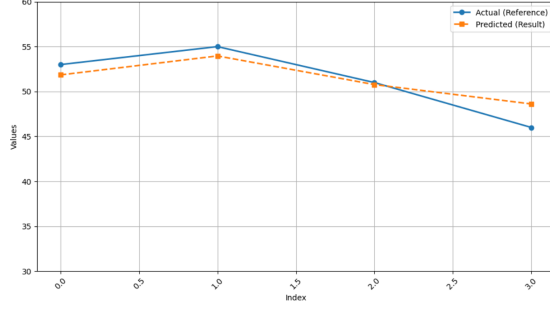
Table 3: Comparison of Forecasting Models across GH1, GM1, and H1 Datasets

Our proposed model results can be seen in Table 4. Our model outperforms the benchmark models at least 17 % in MAE.

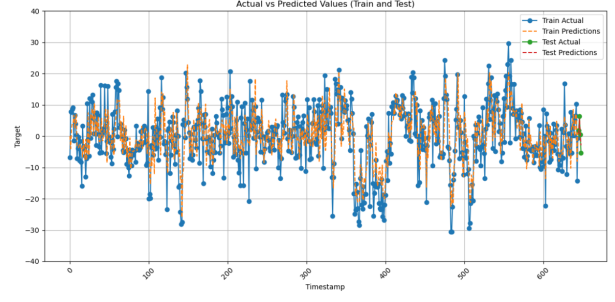
SARIMAX	GH1			GM1			H1		
	MAE	MAPE	Rank	MAE	MAPE	Rank	MAE	MAPE	Rank
SARIMA	1.86	0.04		4.15	0.08		3.66	0.10	
Topological RFE and PSO	1,26	0,02	1	4,09	0,07	1	3,19	0,09	1
Statistical RFE and PSO	1,45	0,03		7,33	0,13		4,16	0,11	

Table 4: Performance of our proposed model on datasets

For each dataset, the best solution’s test data, actual and predicted values, as well as the residual component train data forecasts, can be seen in the Tables 13, 14, and 15 for overfitting analysis. The train MAE and MAPE are greater than the test MAE and MAPE due to the volatile nature of the training set, as we have indicated. Since our aim is to use short-term data and a short forecasting period, these results indicate that the model is generalizing very well and exhibits robust predictive performance.

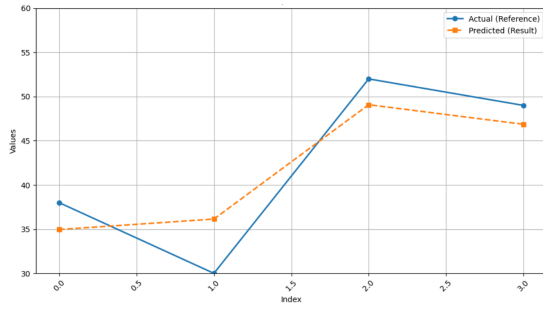


(a) Best Solution of GH1

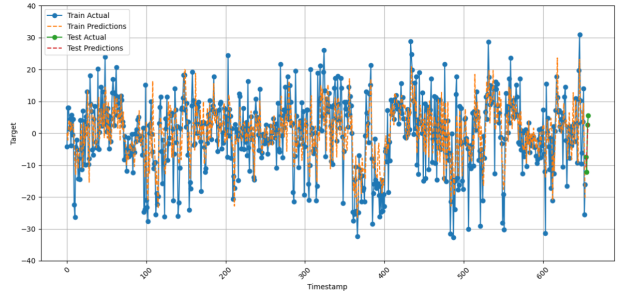


(b) Overfitting Check

Figure 13: Best Solutions for GH1 Dataset: Our Proposed Algorithm with Topological Features

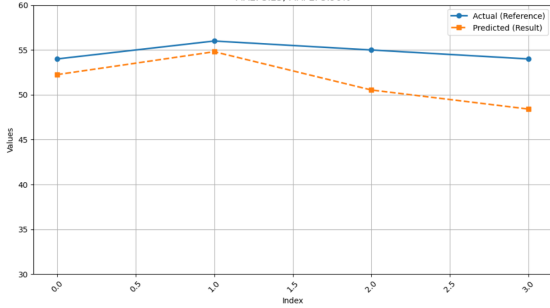


(a) Best Solution of GM1

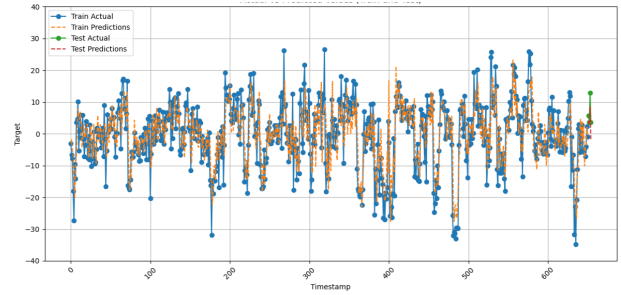


(b) Overfitting Check

Figure 14: Best Solutions for GM1 Dataset: Our Proposed Algorithm with Topological Features



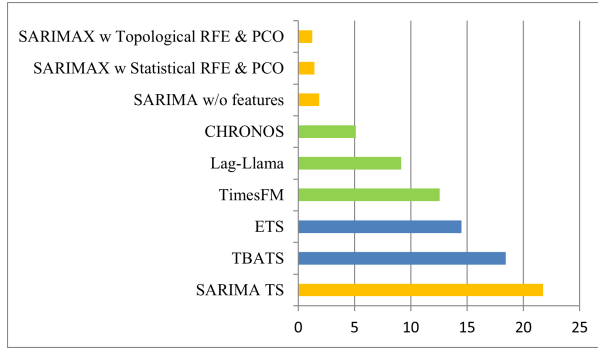
(a) Best Solution of H1



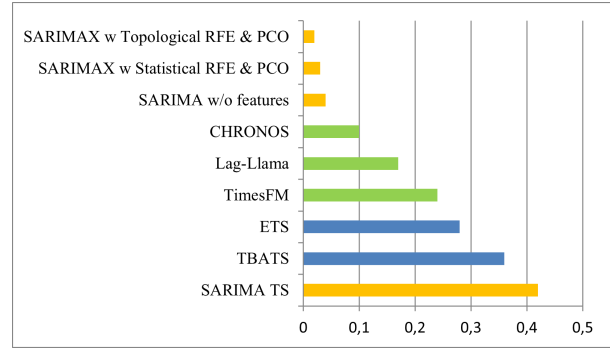
(b) Overfitting Check

Figure 15: Best Solutions for H1 Dataset: Our Proposed Algorithm with Topological Features

Figures 16, 17, and 18 illustrate the comparative performance of different forecasting models across the GH1, GM1, and H1 datasets.

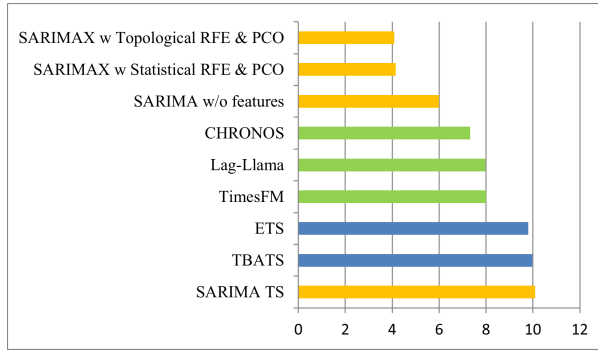


(a) MAE for GH1 Dataset

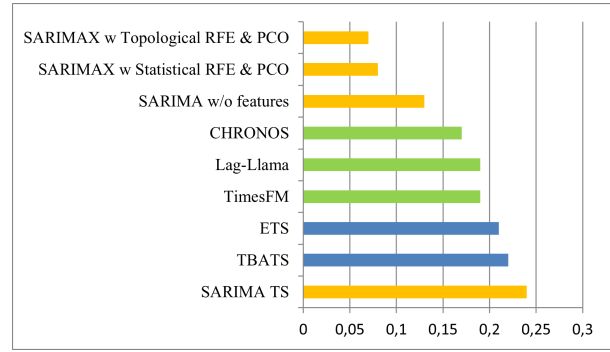


(b) MAPE for GH1 Dataset

Figure 16: MAE and MAPE Comparison for GH1 Dataset

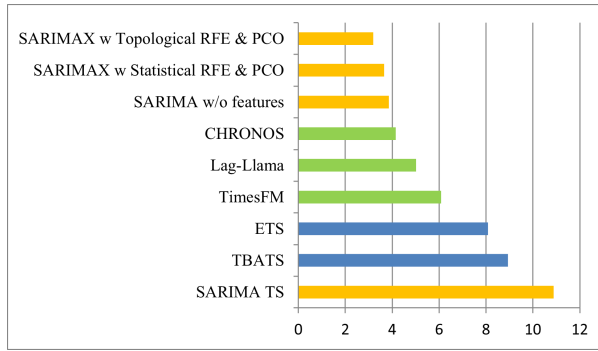


(a) MAE for GM1 Dataset

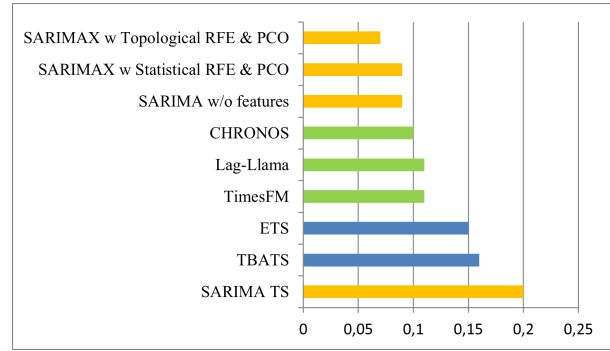


(b) MAPE for GM1 Dataset

Figure 17: MAE and MAPE Comparison for GM1 Dataset



(a) MAE for H1 Dataset



(b) MAPE for H1 Dataset

Figure 18: MAE and MAPE Comparison for H1 Dataset

The SARIMAX model, enhanced with topological features as exogenous variables and optimized through feature selection technique RFE and PSO, delivered the best results when applied to the residual component of the time series decomposition. Since testing all possible feature combinations is an NP-hard problem, PSO was chosen as a heuristic feature selection method. Due to PSO's stochastic nature, the algorithm was executed 15 times,

and the features most frequently selected were taken as an PSO Best dataset. It performs better among all models and feature selection methodologies.

6. Conclusion

This study demonstrates that integrating TDA with classical time series forecasting methods can significantly enhance predictive accuracy in volatile production environments. Our analysis reveals that the selected features—derived from Betti curves and Heat Kernel representations—play a critical role in capturing the underlying complexity of the time series. In fact, the best run features for the H1, GM1, and GH1 datasets clearly underscore the utility of these topological tools in quantifying structural dynamics.

Betti curves and Heat Kernel representations provide additional forecasting power for several reasons:

- 1. Capturing Intrinsic Geometric Structures:** Betti curves summarize topological features such as connectivity and holes across multiple scales, effectively capturing the inherent geometric structure and latent patterns in the data. This multi-scale insight helps identify persistent trends that traditional statistical features might miss.
- 2. Robustness to Noise and Complexity:** Both Betti curves and Heat Kernel methods are inherently robust against noise and fluctuations in the data. In particular, the Heat Kernel models the diffusion of information over the underlying structure, smoothing out irregularities and emphasizing the dominant structural dynamics crucial for accurate predictions.
- 3. Enhanced Feature Representation:** The topological features extracted from these methods offer a complementary view to classical time series characteristics. While traditional models capture temporal dependencies, Betti and Heat Kernel features reveal complex structural patterns. This dual perspective enables a more comprehensive understanding of the data’s dynamics, leading to improved forecasting performance.
- 4. Effective Dimensionality Reduction:** By translating complex, high-dimensional data into succinct topological summaries, these methods reduce the dimensionality of the forecasting problem without losing critical information. This efficient representation simplifies the model’s task of identifying relevant patterns, thereby boosting predictive accuracy.

Integrating these topological tools with SARIMA, leverages the strengths of both approaches and paves the way for more reliable and robust predictions in volatile production environments.

Moreover, our precise decomposition of the seasonal components has proven essential. By isolating these components, the forecasting strategy is markedly improved, enabling more accurate and targeted predictions that reflect the inherent periodicity in the data.

Finally, the effectiveness of the SARIMA model as a forecasting tool is reaffirmed. When augmented with the carefully selected topological features, the SARIMA framework robustly captures the overall dynamics of the system. This integrated approach paves the way for advanced predictive maintenance and operational optimization in modern manufacturing environments.

7. Example Appendix Section

Appendix text.

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